THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

Revision Notes
Class 8 · Social Science

Exploring Society: India and Beyond — Part 1
Chapters 1 to 7 · CBSE / RBSE Syllabus

HOW TO USE THESE NOTES

Each chapter opens with its **Big Questions**, then follows the textbook's own section order. **Bold words** are the keywords examiners look for. Gold boxes hold formal **definitions**; every comparison, classification or timeline from the book has been converted into a **table**. Finish with the navy **Key Takeaways** box — if you have only two minutes before the paper, read that.

CH.	CHAPTER TITLE	CORE THEME
1	Natural Resources and Their Use	Types, distribution, stewardship
2	Reshaping India's Political Map	Sultanate, Vijayanagara, Mughals
3	The Rise of the Marathas	Shivaji, expansion, administration
4	The Colonial Era in India	European powers, British rule, resistance
5	Universal Franchise and India's Electoral System	Voting rights, ECI, election types
6	The Parliamentary System: Legislature and Executive	Parliament, lawmaking, state level
7	Factors of Production	Land, labour, capital, entrepreneurship

CHAPTER 1 · GEOGRAPHY & ECONOMICS

Natural Resources and Their Use

What Nature gives us, how we classify it, and why using it carelessly today destroys the ability of the planet to give it again tomorrow.

Big Questions

- How do we categorise natural resources?
- What is the connection between the distribution of natural resources and different aspects of life?
- What are the implications of unsustainable use / over-exploitation of natural resources?

When Does Nature Become a Resource?

Nature is the totality of life and non-life forms in our environment that humans did not create. When humans use these for sustenance or convert them into new things, they become **resources**.

- Trees in a forest are part of Nature; the same trees become a **resource** when their wood is turned into furniture.
- An entity becomes a resource only if it is **technologically accessible**, **economically feasible** to extract, and **culturally acceptable**.
- Example: petroleum deep under the ocean is not a resource until we have the technology and the cost is justified. Cutting trees in a **sacred grove** may be culturally unacceptable.

NOTE

In this chapter, the word **"exploitation"** is used neutrally — it means *extraction, utilisation and consumption* of natural resources, not necessarily a harmful act.

Categories of Natural Resources

Classification helps us talk about large groups of things with a single word. Natural resources can be grouped either by **use** or by whether they can be **renewed**.

▸ A. Grouped by Use

Category	What it means	Examples
Resources essential for life	Cannot be made by humans; life is impossible without them.	Air, water, food, soil
Resources for materials	Nature's gifts converted into useful or beautiful objects.	Wood, marble, coal, gold
Resources for energy	Power modern living, transport and production.	Coal, water, petroleum, natural gas, sunlight, wind

▸ B. Grouped by Renewability

Nature works in **cycles where there is no waste** — a fallen tree decomposes, feeds bacteria, fungi and insects, and enriches the soil so new trees can grow.

DEFINITIONS

Restoration — returning something to its original healthy state after damage.
Regeneration — Nature's ability to create new life and the conditions for thriving (goes beyond restoration).
Renewable resources — resources that Nature can restore and regenerate over time (solar energy, wind, river water, timber).
Non-renewable resources — resources created over very long periods that cannot be replenished at the rate we use them (coal, petroleum, iron, copper, gold).

- **Condition for renewability:** the natural rhythm of restoration and regeneration must not be disturbed. Harvest timber faster than the forest grows and the forest is depleted.
- **Glacier example:** fossil-fuel industrialisation and deforestation have raised temperatures; Himalayan glaciers now melt faster than precipitation can replace them — threatening the **"water tower"** that feeds the plains.
- **Traditional balance:** communities refrained from fishing during the **spawning season** to maintain fish populations. Commercial fishing caused **over-fishing**; the decline of **tuna** led to international agreements, yet the species is still declining.
- **Non-renewable reality:** India has large coal reserves, but they may last only about **50 more years** at current demand — so coal must be used judiciously until sustainable options become widespread.

KEY DISTINCTION

Ecosystem functions — the inherent ways Nature works (a forest filters water, prevents soil erosion, provides habitat).
Ecosystem services — the benefits humans receive from those functions (clean water, protected farmland, pollinated crops).
Figures: a mature tree produces about **275 litres of oxygen per day**; a human being needs about **350 litres of oxygen per day**.

Distribution of Natural Resources and Its Implications

Natural resources are **not evenly distributed** across the planet or within countries. This unevenness shapes settlement, trade, international relations and conflict.

- Industries set up near resources create **local employment**; townships grow and facilities improve.
- But costs follow: people in resource-rich areas are often **displaced**, and their **sacred places** may be threatened, causing conflict.
- National and international trade depends on the **geographical location** of resources — combined with human skill, this produced unique products such as **Wootz steel**.
- Nature ignores political boundaries, so resources must be shared. Example: the **Kaveri river** is shared by **Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala and Puducherry**, requiring negotiation and careful management to keep the peace.

The 'Natural Resource Curse'

Abundant natural resources do **not** automatically bring prosperity.

DEFINITION

Natural resource curse (or **"paradox of plenty"**) — the phenomenon where regions rich in natural resources can experience *slower* economic growth and development, often because the economy fails to build industries that convert raw resources into higher-value products.

- **India has largely avoided the curse** by investing in industries that process its resources.
- The deciding factors are **human knowledge, good governance and strategic planning** — not the resources themselves.

Responsible and Wise Use of Natural Resources: Stewardship

Stewardship means respecting Nature and using resources so that renewables can restore and regenerate, while non-renewables are used responsibly and judiciously.

Scientists warn that irresponsible treatment of natural resources has caused **pollution, biodiversity loss and climate change**, accelerating in recent years.

▸ Case 1 — Over-exploitation of Groundwater in Punjab

- In the **1960s**, farmers shifted to **high-yielding varieties** of wheat and paddy — these need far more water than traditional seeds.
- Supply of **free power** led to over-pumping of groundwater; chemical pesticides and fertilisers were also used heavily.
- Result: in large parts of Punjab the water table has fallen beyond about **30 metres**, and chemicals dissolved in groundwater cause health hazards.
- About **80% of Punjab's area** is classified as **"over-exploited"** — water is drawn faster than it can be restored.
- Short-term food security was achieved, but the long-term damage will take time and effort to heal.

Remedies tried: traditional water harvesting, rejuvenation of ponds and tanks, cutting wasteful water consumption, and processing and reusing water. For soil: cow dung and natural fertilisers, mulching, multi-cropping and holistic soil management.

▸ Case 2 — The Case of Cement

- Cement is essential for houses, schools, hospitals, bridges, roads and airports, but its production is listed among the **most polluting industries**.
- Fine dust damages human and animal lungs, settles on leaves reducing yields, and pollutes soil and water.
- The **Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)** has issued guidelines for cement factories to minimise or eliminate pollution.
- **Alternatives:** traditional materials like **stone and mud**, new plant-based materials, and recycled materials from waste plastic.

▸ Case 3 — Sikkim: A 100% Organic State

- Pema's family farm faced falling yields and mounting debt from expensive chemical inputs.
- The family switched to **compost**, natural pest repellents from **neem and garlic**, and multiple crops across the year.
- After about five years the farm thrived, selling cardamom, ginger and traditional vegetables at **premium prices**.
- In **2016**, Sikkim became a **100% organic state** with all farmland certified organic.
- Effects: local biodiversity flourished, tourism increased, and farmers' incomes grew by about **20% on average**. Sikkim is now a global model.

▸ Traditional Knowledge — Vrikshayurveda

- An ancient Indian **botanical science** on the study and care of plants and trees.
- From Sanskrit: **vriksha** = tree, **ayurveda** = science of life or health.
- Formalised in texts such as **Surapala's Vrikshayurveda** around the **10th century CE**.
- Covers which plants to grow on which soil types, seed collection and preservation, irrigation by species and season, natural pest repellents, crop rotation and mixed cropping, and ploughing methods that retain soil moisture and support soil organisms (fungi, bacteria, earthworms).

▸ Renewable Energy — India's Leadership

- The **International Solar Alliance** was launched in **2015** by **India and France** — a coalition of sunshine-rich countries committed to harnessing solar power.

- India has helped channel billions of dollars into solar projects in developing nations and shared technical expertise.
- **Bhadla Solar Park** symbolises India's solar ambitions; a large solar park in **Rajasthan** can generate enough electricity to power about **15% of the state's current needs**.
- India's role represents both environmental responsibility and economic opportunity.

> **REMEMBER**
>
> Distribution and access to basic resources such as **water and clean air** are often unfair. Many city areas get irregular drinking water, and air pollution from industries and fossil fuels harms those least able to protect themselves. The **Bhagavad Gita** refers to **lokasangraha** — welfare of all — as the guiding ideal.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Nature becomes a **resource** only when it is technologically accessible, economically feasible and culturally acceptable.
- **Renewable** resources stay renewable only if we do not disturb Nature's rhythm of restoration and regeneration.
- **Non-renewables** (coal, petroleum, minerals) are finite — India's coal may last roughly 50 more years.
- **Uneven distribution** causes displacement, conflict and international tension (Kaveri water dispute).
- The **natural resource curse** is beaten by industry-building, human knowledge, good governance and planning.
- Punjab's groundwater crisis shows the cost of over-exploitation; **Sikkim (2016)** shows a whole state can go 100% organic.
- **Stewardship** — and the ideal of **lokasangraha** — is the way forward.

CHAPTER 2 · HISTORY

Reshaping India’s Political Map

From the 11th to the 17th centuries, wave after wave of invasion and the rise of new dynasties redrew India's political map — while society, economy and culture continually adapted and rebuilt.

Big Questions

- How did foreign invasions and the rise of new dynasties reshape India's political boundaries during this period?
- How did Indian society respond to invasions? How did India's economy adapt during times of political instability?
- What impact did this period have on the lives of the people?

TERM

“Medieval” literally means “between two ages”. It was originally used for European history (fall of Rome to the Renaissance). In this book it simply means the period from the **11th to the 17th centuries** in India.

TIMELINE

1192 — Defeat of King Prithviraj Chauhan; foundation of the Delhi Sultanate.
1326 — Re-establishment of the Mewar Kingdom.
1526 — First Battle of Panipat; Babur's victory establishes the Mughal Empire.
1556 — Second Battle of Panipat; Akbar's decisive victory.
1565 — Battle of Talikota; destruction of Vijayanagara city.
1576 — Battle of Haldighati; Maharana Pratap forced to retreat.
1671 — Battle of Saraighat; the Ahoms defeat the Mughals.
1699 — Formation of the Khalsa by Guru Gobind Singh.

Rise and Fall of the Delhi Sultanate

The Delhi Sultanate was formed after the defeat of **Prithviraj Chauhan in 1192**. Five successive dynasties of Turkic-Afghan origin ruled from Delhi.

The Five Dynasties	Notes
Mamluks (Slave dynasty)	First dynasty; Qutub-ud-din Aibak began the Qutub Minar complex.
Khiljis (Khaljis)	Ala-ud-din Khilji — see below.
Tughlaqs	Muhammad bin Tughlaq — see below.
Sayyids	Short-lived dynasty after Timur's invasion.
Lodis (Lodhis)	Last dynasty; ended by Babur at Panipat in 1526.

- Neighbouring kingdoms such as the **Eastern Gangas** (east) and the **Hoysalas** (south) resisted the Sultanate and became thriving centres of art, culture and administration.
- **Delhi** grew into a major political centre of northern India.
- **Political instability:** almost **two out of three sultans** seized power by eliminating their predecessor; a sultan's average reign was barely **nine years**.
- Military campaigns raided villages and cities and plundered and destroyed temples and seats of learning.

▸ Ala-ud-din Khilji

- Called himself **“Sikander Sani”** — “the second Alexander” — as shown on his coins.
- Around 1300 CE he campaigned across north and central India, sacking and plundering many cities.

- He also **repelled several Mongol invasions** that tried to add India to the Mongol Empire.
- His slave-general **Malik Kafur** expanded southward, conquering kingdoms and attacking Hindu centres such as **Srirangam, Madurai, Chidambaram** and possibly **Rameswaram**. The plunder financed the Sultanate's huge military.

▸ Muhammad bin Tughlaq

- Expanded the Sultanate so that, for the first time since the **Mauryan Empire**, most of the Subcontinent was under one ruler — but the dominance was short-lived.
- **Capital transfer:** moved the capital from Delhi to **Daulatabad** (then Devagiri) hoping for better central control; people were forced to travel over **1,000 km**. The plan failed and the capital was shifted back — both transfers caused great loss of life.
- **Token currency:** cheap copper coins were declared to have the value of silver or gold coins. The idea was progressive (most modern currency is token), but it created confusion in trade and encouraged counterfeiting, causing economic decline.

▸ Timur’s Invasion and the End of the Sultanate

- At the end of the 14th century, **Timur**, a Turkic-Mongol conqueror, invaded northwest India and devastated **Delhi**.
- He stated his two-fold aim: to wage **“war with the infidels”** and to **plunder the wealth of the infidels**.
- Large numbers were killed or enslaved; the city was left in ruins. Timur withdrew with huge plunder, leaving chaos.
- The **Lodis** then emerged as the last dynasty, by which time the Sultanate's territory had shrunk greatly.

TERMS

Jizya — a tax on non-Muslim subjects, in theory in return for protection and exemption from military service; in practice often a source of economic burden and public humiliation, and an incentive to convert.
Iconoclasm — the rejection or destruction of religious images considered idolatrous. Attacks on Buddhist, Jain and Hindu temple images were motivated by plunder *and* iconoclasm.
Image — the neutral English term used here; Indian classical texts used *murti, vigraha, pratima, rupa*. “Idol” and “icon” are considered pejorative in the context of Judaism, Christianity and Islam.

Resistance to the Delhi Sultanate

Resister	Key facts
Eastern Ganga kingdom of Kalinga	Covered present-day Odisha and parts of Bengal and Andhra Pradesh. Ruler **Narasimhadeva I** (mid-13th century) repelled multiple Sultanate inroads and defeated the Sultanate's governor of Bengal. He built the **Surya temple at Konark** partly to commemorate these victories.
Musunuri Nayakas	Telugu chieftains who rallied over **75 chieftains** into a confederacy, defeated the Sultanate forces and expelled Muhammad bin Tughlaq's army from **Warangal** around **1330–1336**.
Hoysalas	Ruled parts of present-day Karnataka; fended off several attacks and remained the only independent kingdom in the south for a time. Weakened by attacks and internal conflict, they were absorbed into the **Vijayanagara Empire** in the mid-14th century. Built magnificent temples at **Belur** and **Halebidu**. Their emblem comes from the story of **Sala**, who fought a lion to save his guru — “Hoy (strike)! Sala”.
Bahmani Sultanate	Rose in the mid-14th century and controlled much of the Deccan. Powerful Sultanates also emerged in **Gujarat** and **Bengal**.
Rana Kumbha of Mewar	15th-century ruler of Mewar (central/southern Rajasthan) who resisted the later Sultanates. Built **Kumbhalgarh Fort** in the Aravalli hills, famous for its massive **36-km-long wall** — one of the longest continuous walls in the world.

The Vijayanagara Empire

As the Delhi Sultanate grew unstable, a new power rose in the south.

- Founded in the 14th century by two brothers, **Harihara and Bukka**, who had earlier served as governors under Muhammad bin Tughlaq and then rejected Delhi's authority.
- Folklore: at **Hampi** they saw a hare chasing a pack of hounds — a symbol of unexpected strength. Their guru **Vidyaranya** advised them to build their capital there.
- Chief rival to the north: the **Bahmani Sultanate**, which later fragmented into the **five Deccan Sultanates** — **Bijapur, Golconda, Berar, Ahmednagar and Bidar**.
- The Vijayanagara rulers also fought the **Gajapati rulers of Odisha** in the east.

▸ Krishnadevaraya (16th century)

- Brought the empire to its peak, expanding and securing dominance over the Deccan.
- Patronised poets and scholars in **Sanskrit, Telugu and Kannada**.
- He himself composed the Telugu epic **Amuktamalyada** on the Tamil poet-saint **Andal**; one section, the **Rajaniti**, explains his ideas of good governance.
- Gave grants to temples including **Tirupati** and the **Vitthala temple** at Vijayanagara, famous for its **musical pillars**.
- Portuguese travellers were well treated because they sold horses, which the king did not want sold to enemy kingdoms.
- **Domingo Paes** left a detailed record: the city “seemed to me as large as Rome… the best provided city in the world”.
- Died of illness in **1529**.

▸ Fall of Vijayanagara

- In **1565**, the Deccan Sultanates formed a coalition and defeated Vijayanagara forces led by **Ramaraya**, Krishnadevaraya's son-in-law, at the **Battle of Talikota**.
- The city was sacked over several months — houses, shops, palaces and most temples destroyed, much of the civilian population massacred.
- The empire fragmented into smaller regions ruled by **Nayakas** (former military governors) and ended in the mid-17th century.

The Mughals

▸ Babur and the Founding of the Empire

- **Babur**, a Turkic-Mongol ruler and descendant of Timur, was pushed out of **Samarkand** and turned to India.
- He defeated **Ibrahim Lodi** at the **First Battle of Panipat (1526)**, ending the Delhi Sultanate and founding the Mughal Empire. The battle relied on **gunpowder, field artillery and matchlock guns**, recently introduced to Indian warfare.
- Wrote the **Baburnama** — a candid autobiography. He was cultured and curious (architecture, poetry, birds, fruit trees) but also a ruthless conqueror who slaughtered city populations and erected **“towers of skulls”**.
- He found India a “country of few charms” but acknowledged: “Hindustan is a large country and has masses of gold and silver… There are countless artisans and workmen of every sort.”

▸ Humayun, Sher Shah Suri and Hemu

- After Babur's death in **1530**, **Humayun** struggled to hold the empire together.
- **Sher Shah Suri**, an Afghan leader, established the **Sur Empire** over large parts of north India and introduced lasting reforms — but it was short-lived as Humayun reconquered the lost ground.

- **Hemu (Hemchandra Vikramaditya)**, a skilled commander and *wazir* under a later Suri ruler, captured Delhi and ruled briefly. He was injured at the **Second Battle of Panipat** against Akbar, captured and beheaded.

▸ Akbar (1556–1605)

- Declared emperor at the age of **13** on Humayun's accidental death. His reign blended **brutality and tolerance**.
- **Chittorgarh (Chittor):** besieged for over five months against determined Rajput resistance. When the fort fell, hundreds of women committed **jauhar**; Akbar ordered the massacre of about **30,000 civilians** and surviving women and children were enslaved. He was 25.
- His victory message read that the Mughals had “destroyed temples in those places and also all over Hindustan”.
- **Later strategy of tolerance:** marriage alliances with neighbouring princesses, welcoming Rajput and regional leaders into his court, **abolishing the jizya**, and promoting **sulh-i-kul** — “peace with all”, tolerance of all faiths.
- Appointed Hindu officials to high positions and held interfaith dialogues.
- Reign lasted almost **50 years**; the middle period was relatively peaceful, the final 15 years involved campaigns in Kashmir, Sindh, the Deccan and Afghanistan.
- Though illiterate, he was keen on Persian and Indian texts and set up a **“house of translation”** at **Fatehpur Sikri**, where the **Mahabharata** (Razmnama, “Book of War”), the **Ramayana** (with 176 miniature paintings), the **Bhagavad Gita** and the **Panchatantra** were translated into Persian.

> **TERM**
>
> **Jauhar** — mass self-immolation by Rajput women to avoid capture and enslavement by invading armies; regarded as a heroic act of final resistance and a means of preserving honour.

▸ Jahangir, Shah Jahan and Aurangzeb

Ruler	Key points
Jahangir	Shared his father's love of art and architecture; tried to expand into the Deccan.
Shah Jahan	Fought several rebellions; best remembered as the builder of the **Taj Mahal** at Agra. This period was the peak of Mughal art and architecture — **Humayun's tomb**, the **Red Forts** of Delhi and Agra — along with calligraphy and miniature painting.
Aurangzeb	Defeated and executed his eldest brother **Dara Shikoh** (whose severed head was presented to Shah Jahan), removed his other brothers, and imprisoned his father in Agra Fort. Crowned in **1658**, taking the title **Alamgir** (“conqueror of the world”); ruled almost **49 years**.

- Under Aurangzeb the Mughal empire reached its **greatest expansion**, but he faced constant rebellions and spent the last **25 years** fighting in the Deccan. Maintaining huge armies drained the treasury — a key factor in the rapid decline of Mughal power after his death in **1707**.
- A Sunni Muslim, he led an austere life and **reimposed the jizya** on non-Muslims and a **pilgrimage tax** on Hindus — both abolished by Akbar. He also banned music and dance in his court.
- In **1669** he ordered governors “to demolish schools and temples of the infidels and put down their teachings and religious practices.” Temples at **Banaras (Varanasi), Mathura and Somnath** were destroyed, as were Jain temples and Sikh gurdwaras.
- He also persecuted Muslims of other sects, including **Sufis**, and **Zoroastrians (Parsis)**.
- Some scholars argue his motives were mainly political, citing grants and protection he gave to some temples — but his own **farmans** (edicts) show personal religious motive as well.

> **REIGN LENGTHS (COMPARE)**
>
> Delhi sultans: average reign about **9 years**. Mughal emperors up to Aurangzeb: about **27 years**. All Mughal rulers to the end of the empire: about **16 years**.

Resistance to the Mughals

Who resisted	Key facts
Jat peasantry	17th century, in present-day western Uttar Pradesh, Haryana and eastern Rajasthan. They killed an oppressive Mughal officer; in a later battle **20,000 men** fought the Mughal army valiantly but their leader was killed and the rebellion suppressed.
Tribal groups	The **Bhils, Gonds, Santhals and Kochs** fought attempts to annex their territory or impose taxes.
Rani Durgavati	Valiant queen of the **Garha kingdom** (a Gond kingdom in central India). Ruled wisely, kept an army of **20,000 soldiers and 1,000 elephants**, and repelled several invasions. In **1564**, when a general sent by Akbar attacked, she fought bravely despite being outnumbered and outmatched; wounded, she took her own life to avoid capture. She was only **40**.
Rana Sanga	Early 16th century; unified several Rajput clans and won many battles against sultans, finally defeated by Babur at the **Battle of Khanwa**.
Maharana Pratap	Ruler of Mewar who refused Mughal suzerainty. At the **Battle of Haldighati (1576)** in the Aravallis the Mughals had the upper hand, but he escaped and waged **guerrilla warfare** from the hills for years. He received strong support from the **Bhils**, who served as archers and knew the terrain — earning a respected place in Mewar's military tradition, as the **Mewar emblem** shows.
Durga Das Rathore	Rajput noble of **Marwar** who rebelled during Aurangzeb's reign, fighting to protect the independence of **Jodhpur**. Mughal authority thus remained limited in Rajasthan.

▸ The Ahoms

- Migrated from present-day **Myanmar** in the 13th century into the **Brahmaputra Valley** and formed the Ahom kingdom.
- Resisted expansion during both the Sultanate and Mughal periods.
- **Paik system:** every able-bodied man gave service to the state through labour or military duty in exchange for land rights — allowing rulers to build public infrastructure and maintain a large standing force **without a permanent army**.
- The Ahoms assimilated local culture, promoted agriculture, encouraged diverse faiths and enriched Assam's traditions.
- In the 17th century, Aurangzeb's forces briefly captured the Ahom capital **Garhgaon**. The Ahoms used knowledge of dense forests, hills and rivers with persistent guerrilla tactics to repel the attack.
- **Battle of Saraighat (1671)**, on the Brahmaputra near present-day Guwahati: commander **Lachit Borphukan** and his **10,000** men defeated a Mughal force of **30,000**. Ahom independence was preserved.
- Mughal general **Ram Singh** praised the Ahoms: “Every Assamese soldier is expert in rowing boats, in shooting arrows, in digging trenches, and in wielding guns and cannons.”

▸ The Rise of the Sikhs

- In 15th-century Punjab, **Guru Nanak** spread the message of equality, compassion and the oneness of God (**Ik Onkar**); his followers became the **Sikhs**.
- What began as a spiritual movement had to respond to persecution under later Mughal rulers. Emperor **Jahangir** had **Guru Arjan** tortured to death for supporting his rebellious son.
- Guru Arjan's son **Guru Hargobind** introduced martial training and formed a Sikh army that fought several battles against Mughal forces.
- The **Guru Granth Sahib** was first compiled by Guru Arjan; hymns of **Guru Tegh Bahadur** were added later. It stresses one God for all and values of truthfulness, compassion, humility and self-control — “Truth is high but higher still is truthful living.”
- In **1675**, Kashmir Pandits sought protection from persecution. **Guru Tegh Bahadur** stood with them and accepted martyrdom; Aurangzeb ordered him to convert, and on his refusal he was publicly beheaded in **Chandni Chowk, Delhi**.

- His son **Guru Gobind Singh**, the 10th and last Guru, established the **Khalsa** in **1699** — a martial brotherhood committed to justice, equality and defence of the faith.
- Later, as Mughal power declined, several Sikh confederacies emerged in Punjab and were unified by **Maharaja Ranjit Singh** at the turn of the 19th century, creating a strong, centralised Sikh Empire that lasted till the mid-19th century.

> **DID YOU KNOW**
>
> **Gurudwara Sis Ganj Sahib** in Chandni Chowk, Delhi, marks the site where Guru Tegh Bahadur was beheaded in 1675. The Sikh Regiment has saluted this gurudwara before the President in the Republic Day parade every year since **1979**.

Administering India

▸ Administration under the Delhi Sultanate

- Centred on the **sultan**, who held absolute political and military authority. Contemporary chronicles listed his duties as defending the territories of Islam, collecting taxes, and keeping in touch with public affairs.
- Assisted by a **council of ministers** in charge of various departments.
- **Iqta system:** territories were assigned to nobles (**iqtadars**) to collect taxes; after expenses, the surplus went to the Sultan's treasury, mainly to maintain the army. It created a network of local administrators loyal to the centre, and the posts were **not hereditary**.
- Taxes were levied on trade at every stage, but the heaviest burden fell on the **peasantry**; some accounts report considerable cruelty in revenue extraction.

▸ The Mughal Administrative Framework (Akbar)

Officer	Responsibility
Diwan	Finances
Mir Bakhshi	Military matters
Khan-i-Saman	Public works, trade, industry, agriculture and the royal household
Sadr	Justice, religious and educational matters

- The empire was divided into **twelve provinces (subahs)**, further subdivided, with checks and balances between officials.
- At the **village level**, traditional structures of self-governance continued more or less undisturbed.
- **Mansabdari system:** as recorded in Abul Fazl's **Ain-i-Akbari**, **mansabdars** (officers) were graded by **mansab** (rank) and had to maintain a precise number of elephants, horses, camels and troops for the state. This allowed an army to be assembled at short notice without a permanent centralised army. Regular inspections ensured compliance.
- Mansabdars were generally paid by being assigned land (**jagirs**) and were therefore also called **jagirdars**.
- Despite growing tolerance, **non-Muslims remained a minority** in the higher administration — rarely exceeding one-third of officials, often much less. Even among Muslim officials, those of foreign origin were generally favoured over Indian-born ones.
- **Todar Mal**, Akbar's finance minister, introduced an efficient revenue system with detailed surveys of crop yields and prices, and a systematic land survey of the whole empire — boosting revenue and strengthening the state.

People’s Lives

- Despite shifting political power, India had vibrant economic activity — agrarian foundations, thriving artisanal industries, community- and temple-based economies, and extensive trade networks.

- Decentralised systems included **Shrenis** (guilds), **jatis** (professionally defined communities) and systems of credit. The Subcontinent remained one of the world's wealthiest regions.
- The Sultanate period saw progress in **roads, bridges, a few canals and irrigation works**, plus new cities — all expanded greatly under the Mughals.
- Currency: the Sultanate issued coins in several metals and denominations. The Mughals used the silver **rupaya** and copper **dam**.
- **Agriculture** was the mainstay. Land revenue was typically **one-fifth of the produce**, though some sultans raised it to **one-half**. Irrigation expanded (e.g. the **Persian wheel**), allowing multiple crops — food crops (rice, wheat, barley, pulses, sugarcane, spices) and non-food crops (cotton, silk, wool, dyes, timber, jute).
- **Crafts:** textiles, weapons, utensils, ornaments, jewellery. **Ship-building** developed considerably for river and overseas trade.
- **Exports** went through ports such as **Calicut, Mangalore, Surat, Masulipatnam** and **Hooghly**. India imported far less than it exported; imports included silk, horses, metals and luxury goods. Merchants from **Arabia, Persia and Central Asia** settled in Indian ports.
- **Hundi system:** a written instruction to make payment to an individual, carried across political borders — a precursor to modern banking. Trader communities such as the **Marwaris** became adept at operating across regimes, developing parallel systems of credit and trust.
- **Temples as economic centres:** ruling classes donated land and wealth (**dana**) to temple deities, held in trust by temple managers who developed irrigation, tanks and pilgrim accommodations (**dharmashalas** and **chhatrams**). Temples provided merchants with credit and funded maritime trade.
- **Late 1600s — economic stress:** peasants were left with a small share after taxes and payments to intermediaries; many lost land and became **bonded labourers**. Craftspeople and labourers often faced harsh conditions. Frequent warfare caused forced displacement.
- By and large, people of different faiths and communities **lived peacefully side by side**, economically dependent on each other, though there were clashes over desecrated or destroyed sacred sites.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Five dynasties ruled under the **Delhi Sultanate** (Mamluks, Khiljis, Tughlaqs, Sayyids, Lodis); sultan's average reign was only about **9 years**.
- **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** shifted the capital to Daulatabad and introduced token currency — both failed.
- **Vijayanagara** peaked under **Krishnadevaraya** (Amuktamalyada) and fell at the **Battle of Talikota, 1565**.
- **Babur** founded the Mughal Empire at the **First Battle of Panipat (1526)**; Akbar expanded it through both conquest and **sulh-i-kul**; Aurangzeb's Deccan wars drained the treasury.
- Resistance came from the **Rajputs, Ahoms (Saraighat, 1671), Sikhs (Khalsa, 1699), Rani Durgavati and the Jats**.
- Administration: **iqta** (Sultanate) and **mansabdari/jagir** (Mughal), with **Todar Mal's** revenue reforms.
- Economy stayed vibrant through **shrenis, jatis, hundis** and temple-based credit — but the common subject's life remained harsh.

CHAPTER 3 · HISTORY

The Rise of the Marathas

How a people of the Deccan plateau, inspired by bhakti saints and led by Chhatrapati Shivaji, built the largest Indian power before the British — and why the British took India from them more than from any other power.

Big Questions

- Who were the Marathas? How did they manage to become the largest pan-Indian power before the British took over?
- What were some features of their governance?
- What impact did the Maratha Empire leave on Indian history?

TIMELINE

1630 — Birth of Chhatrapati Shivaji.
1646 — Beginning of Chhatrapati Shivaji's rule.
1657 — Founding of the Maratha navy.
1666 — Imprisonment at, and escape from, Agra.
1674 — Chhatrapati Shivaji's coronation at Raigad.
1677 — Dakshina digvijaya (conquest of the South).
1680 — Death of Chhatrapati Shivaji.
1682–1707 — Mughal–Maratha wars.

Who Are the Marathas?

- A group of people native to the **Deccan plateau**, more specifically present-day **Maharashtra**.
- Identified with the language they speak — **Marathi** — which has had a rich and continuous **literary history since the 12th century**.
- In the 13th century most of Maharashtra was ruled by the **Yadava dynasty**, with **Devagiri** (present-day Daulatabad) as its capital. In the early 14th century the Yadavas were overcome by the **Khilji Sultanate** from Delhi.

▸ The Bhakti Foundation

- Between the **7th and 17th centuries**, saints and seekers across India preferred the path of **bhakti** (devotion) to mere external ritualism.
- They came from diverse sections of society and composed devotional songs and poetry **in the languages of the masses**, so their messages travelled far and wide.
- In Maharashtra, popular saints included **Dnyaneshwar, Namdev, Tukaram and Ramdas**.
- They helped translate important texts such as the **Upanishads** and the **Bhagavad Gita** into Marathi, making their philosophy accessible to the people.
- Some also focused on **social organisation and political awareness**, similar to the Sikh gurus.
- **Result:** society acquired a solid cultural foundation, which later helped the Marathas organise into a political power.
- By the 17th century some Maratha chiefs made early attempts at sovereignty, but these failed — until **Chhatrapati Shivaji** rose to power.

Foundation of Maratha Power and the Rise of Chhatrapati Shivaji

- Born in **1630** in the **Bhonsle clan** to **Shahji** and **Jijabai**. Shahji served the Deccan sultanates and was often away.
- Shivaji grew up at the **jagir at Pune** under Jijabai's watchful eyes and trusted officials, receiving values and a good education.
- The Pune region was deeply affected by constant infighting between the Deccan sultans, causing hardship for common people.
- At just **16**, he launched military campaigns, first consolidating hold over Pune by capturing **neglected and unoccupied forts** and strengthening their defences.
- His vision of a sovereign kingdom — **Swarajya** — grew over the years to cover political, economic and cultural aspects.

▸ Building the Navy

- As his kingdom expanded to India's **west coast**, he saw the need for a navy to secure coastal resources — a **truly revolutionary step** at the time.
- The **Bijapur Sultanate** (Adil Shahi dynasty) maintained merchant ships but had **no full-time naval force**; even the Mughal navy was very limited.
- The **Maratha Navy** was born; its exploits became legendary. **Sindhudurg Fort** (near the Maharashtra–Goa border) is one of several naval fortifications built by the Marathas.

▸ Military Campaigns and Famous Episodes

Episode	What happened
Afzal Khan & Pratapgad	The Bijapur Sultanate sent veteran general **Afzal Khan**. Shivaji's advisers persuaded him to meet one-on-one at the foot of **Pratapgad fort** amid thick forests. Shivaji killed Afzal Khan with the **wagh nakh** (tiger's claw), and the Marathas hidden in the mountains routed the Khan's army with guerrilla attacks.
Raid on Shaista Khan	Mughal nobleman **Shaista Khan** invaded with a big army for three years. Shivaji raided his camp at night with only a few soldiers; the Khan barely escaped, losing a few fingers, and promptly left Maharashtra. This daring raid resembles a modern-day **surgical strike**.
Sacking of Surat	As retaliation, Shivaji sacked **Surat**, a wealthy Mughal port city (present-day Gujarat), obtaining treasure worth almost **one crore of rupees**. He was careful not to attack religious places and spared the house of **Mohandas Parekh**, a charitable man. He sacked Surat again a few years later. The events appeared in the **London Gazette**.
Treaty of Purandar	Aurangzeb sent the Rajput general **Jai Singh**. Shivaji conceded defeat at **Purandar Fort** (near Pune), gave up a sizeable part of his kingdom, and his son **Sambhaji** entered Mughal service.
Agra & the escape	Persuaded by Jai Singh to visit the Mughal court at **Agra**, Shivaji was made to stand before Aurangzeb and a Mughal general he had defeated. Insulted, he stormed out and was placed under house arrest. He began distributing gifts — fruit and sweets in big baskets — to holy men and Mughal generals. Guards checked at first, then stopped; Shivaji and Sambhaji hid in the baskets and escaped. Aurangzeb never captured him again.

▸ Coronation and Southern Conquest

- In **1674**, Shivaji was crowned with full Vedic rites at the strong mountain fortress of **Raigad**.
- His formal title: **“Shri Raja Shiva Chhatrapati”**. Like some past rulers, he started his own era, the **Rajyabhishaka shaka**.
- He then undertook the **dakshina-digvijaya** — conquest of the South — including present-day northern Tamil Nadu and parts of Karnataka. This southern extension later gave the Marathas great **strategic depth** against Mughal invasion.
- A fever claimed his life when he was **fifty**.

REPUTATION

Europeans compared Shivaji with ancient generals like **Alexander**. The Bundela prince **Chhatrasal** was so inspired that he created an independent kingdom of **Bundelkhand** (divided between present-day Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh). The Hindi poet **Bhushan** came to Maharashtra specifically to meet him and composed poems in his praise.

The Marathas After Chhatrapati Shivaji

- Shivaji had two sons — **Sambhaji** and **Rajaram**.
- **Sambhaji** became Chhatrapati. Aurangzeb invaded the Deccan, conquered the **Bijapur (Adil Shahi)** and **Golconda (Qutb Shahi)** Sultanates, captured Sambhaji, tortured him brutally and executed him. He then captured **Raigad**, the Maratha capital.
- **Rajaram** became Chhatrapati and fled to **Gingee** (present-day Tamil Nadu), spreading the Mughal–Maratha conflict to south India.
- The Marathas staunchly defended their fortresses and often had the upper hand. Aurangzeb was unable to leave the Deccan and died without subduing them.
- No longer on the defensive, the Marathas under **Tarabai**, Rajaram's queen, made large-scale inroads into Mughal territories and eventually conquered large parts of India.
- **Structural change:** the centralised state of Shivaji's time gave way to a more **decentralised** structure — still nominally centred on the Chhatrapati, but with chiefs wielding more power. The **Peshwa** (Persian for prime minister) gained great influence, even over the Chhatrapati himself.
- **Peshwa Bajirao I** and his son **Nanasaheb Peshwa** were instrumental in the pan-Indian expansion.
- **Downside:** with regional chiefs gaining autonomy, there was occasional indiscipline and abuse — for instance, the Marathas' **ten-year campaign in Bengal** inflicted much cruelty and devastation on common people.

▸ Northward Expansion and Decline

- The Marathas briefly controlled **Lahore, Attock and even Peshawar** (in modern-day Pakistan).
- They fought the Afghans and suffered a disastrous defeat at **Panipat in 1761**, but recovered quickly under **Peshwa Madhavrao I**.
- Under **Mahadji Shinde (Mahadji Scindia)**, they recaptured **Delhi in 1771**, which remained under their control till the British captured it three decades later.
- In the latter half of the 18th century the chief rivals of the British in India were the Marathas.
- **Three Anglo-Maratha wars (1775–1818)**: owing to increased internal disunity among the Marathas and the superior organisational and technological abilities of the British, Maratha power ended.
- **In effect, the British took India from the Marathas more than from the Mughals or any other power.**

Maratha Administration

▸ Civilian Administration

- Shivaji instituted a relatively **centralised administration**.
- He **abolished hereditary posts** (common under the Sultans and Mughals) and land assignments, and paid a **salary** to every government official out of the state treasury.
- Many officials were **periodically transferred** so that none could gain enough power to dictate terms to the king.
- He gave **pensions to widows of soldiers** who died in battle and offered military posts to their sons.
- He issued strict instructions to officials **not to mistreat subjects** or forcefully grab even a blade of grass. In a letter he wrote that teak could be cut for the navy with permission, but mango and jackfruit trees must not be touched because they take many years to mature and “the people look after them like their children”; he added, “If you accomplish something by oppressing others, it perishes soon, along with the oppressor.”

▸ The Ashta Pradhana Mandala — Council of Eight Ministers

Minister	Portfolio
Pradhan	Prime Minister
Amatya	Finance Minister
Sachiv	Land Revenue Minister
Mantri	Intelligence Minister
Nyayadhish	Chief Justice
Sumant	Minister for Foreign Affairs
Senapati	Commander-in-chief
Panditrao	Head of Religious Affairs

▸ Taxes

- **Chauth** — 25% levied from provinces not directly under the Marathas, including parts of the Deccan and north India.
- **Sardeshmukhi** — an additional 10% on top of chauth.
- In return, the Marathas protected those provinces and did not intervene in their internal administration. The Mughals approved this arrangement through various treaties, and over time some of these provinces became part of the Maratha Empire.

▸ Military Administration

- Armed forces divided into three parts — **infantry, cavalry and navy**.
- Cavalry had two types of soldiers: **bargirs** (horses and equipment paid for by the state) and **shiledars** (horses and equipment paid for by the soldiers themselves).
- In the 18th century the Marathas noticed the superiority of **European-style disciplined troops and artillery** and tried to raise such troops. **Mahadji Shinde** had a large European-style army.
- Preferred weapons: **swords and lances**; guns were also used in sizable numbers. **Rockets** were used from Shivaji's days, and by **1770** metal tube rockets were in use.
- **Forts** were initially the mainstay of Maratha power — essential to control strategic routes and shelter the army during guerrilla warfare.

> **SOURCE QUOTE**
>
> **Ramachandrapant Amatya**, Shivaji's finance minister, wrote in the **Adnyapatra** (“The Royal Edict”, 1715): “Forts are the core of the state. In their absence, the land gets devastated in the face of an invasion… it was due to forts that the [Maratha] state survived despite decades of onslaught.”

▸ Maritime Supremacy

- In the 18th century, **Kanhoji Angre** guided the Marathas to victory in many naval battles through clever use of geography and tactics, despite Maratha ships being less advanced than European ones.
- Europeans forced Indians to buy naval trade passes (**cartaz** in Portuguese); any ship without a pass was confiscated. The Marathas challenged this and began demanding passes **from the Europeans themselves** — who showed their frustration by labelling Kanhoji Angre a **“pirate”**.
- In **1665**, four ships of Shivaji's fleet reached **Muscat** (capital of Oman). The ruler captured them and arrested the men, and prepared ships to attack Shivaji's coast — but on hearing that the Maratha navy contained **more than a hundred ships**, he retreated into the harbour.

▸ Judicial System

- Efficient, and remarkable for its **moderation in using capital punishment**.

- The **panchayat** (a local gathering of officials and prominent men — not the modern governmental body) was the main body delivering justice.
- An appeal could be made to a Maratha chief if the verdict was unsatisfactory.
- In towns such as **Pune and Indore**, the **kotwal** (police) ensured law and order.

▸ Trade Networks

- Shivaji encouraged trade and personally participated in maritime foreign trade; he and his officials owned ships.
- Ports reached included **Mocha (Yemen), Muscat (Oman) and Malacca (Malaysia)**. Cargo included gold, textiles and more.
- Roads were constructed and maintained; in places such as **Odisha** in the 18th century a network of **ferries** was maintained for riverine transport, and bridges were built over rivers and streams.

Cultural Revival

- Shivaji's vision of Swarajya is evident in his **seal**, which carried a **Sanskrit inscription** — a notable departure from the prevalent Persian seals: “This seal of Chhatrapati Shivaji, the son of Shahji, waxing like the new moon, revered by the world, reigns for the welfare (of the people).”
- He commissioned the **Rajya-Vyavahara-Kosha** to promote Marathi, providing **Sanskrit equivalents for Persian words** used in diplomacy — greatly reducing foreign loanwords in Maratha diplomacy.
- A devout Hindu who respected other religions, he rebuilt desecrated temples and promoted Sanskrit and Marathi literature, religious institutions and traditional arts. His **saffron flag** was adopted by all Marathas.
- His greatest contribution was the demonstration that mighty kingdoms and empires could be defeated, and that the Marathas could maintain, expand and administer an empire of their own.

▸ Notable Maratha Women

Person	Contribution
Tarabai	Fearless warrior queen who ruled in the early 18th century after the death of her husband **Rajaram**. Realising that with Aurangzeb and the Mughal army in the Deccan, north India was unprotected, she organised large Maratha armies and sent them to invade Mughal territories in the north. She was the **architect of the northward Maratha expansion**; her strategy and tenacity preserved Maratha independence during a critical period.
Ahilyabai Holkar	Of the **Holkar dynasty**, which ruled a considerable kingdom in central India around present-day **Indore**. Even after losing her husband and son, she governed for **thirty years**, administering wisely and caring for the common people. She built and restored hundreds of temples, **ghats**, wells and roads across India, from **Kedarnath** in the north to **Rameswaram** in the south. Most famously she rebuilt the **Kashi Vishwanath temple** at Varanasi (destroyed by Aurangzeb) and the **Somnath temple** in Gujarat (destroyed by Mahmud of Ghazni). She also promoted the **Maheshwar weaving industry** in Madhya Pradesh.

DID YOU KNOW

The **Modi script** — a cursive form of Devanagari — was the main script used by the Marathas for correspondence. The **Bhonsles of Nagpur** supported local culture, and the worship of **Jagannath at Puri** (Odisha), often interrupted under Mughal rule, was revived with Maratha support.

▸ In Focus: Thanjavur

- **Ekoji**, Shivaji's half-brother, conquered the **Thanjavur** region (present-day Tamil Nadu) in the late 17th century, beginning Maratha rule there.
- The Thanjavur Marathas created a **syncretic culture** rich in innovation; many rulers were themselves poets and dramatists.
- **Serfoji II** was the most notable. Well-versed in many Indian and European languages, he wrote a Marathi play, **Devendra Kuravanji**, describing world geography.

- He patronised many musicians; modern **Carnatic music** took shape in his time, as did the early stages of **Bharatanatyam**.
- Interested in medicine, he established the **Dhanwantari Mahal**, a centre offering free treatment using both Indian and Western medicine.
- He started a **printing press** — the first such example in India by a native ruler.
- He got the history of the **Bhonsle family** inscribed on the walls of the **Brihadishwara temple** at Thanjavur — one of the largest single inscriptions in India.
- The cultural environment of Thanjavur was **multilingual** — Tamil, Telugu and Marathi interacted freely.

The Maratha Legacy

- Maratha rule **challenged Mughal dominance** and established the **largest Indian empire before the British**, controlling much of central and northern India.
- They set up a new way of governing with an **efficient administration**, and revived local Hindu traditions **without religious discrimination**.
- Their brave fight against oppressive rule and foreign power was driven by the fiery ideal of **Swarajya**.
- This later inspired many Indians to believe they could govern themselves — planting the early seeds of India's freedom movement.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj** founded the Maratha kingdom in the 17th century; born 1630, crowned at **Raigad in 1674**.
- Key episodes: **Afzal Khan (wagh nakh)**, the night raid on **Shaista Khan**, the **sacking of Surat**, the **escape from Agra**.
- He created a **navy** (1657) — revolutionary for its time — and relied on **guerrilla warfare** and **forts**.
- Administration: **Ashta Pradhana Mandala**, salaried (non-hereditary) officials, the **Adnyapatra**, taxes of **chauth (25%)** and **sardeshmukhi (+10%)**.
- After Shivaji: **Sambhaji**, **Rajaram**, **Tarabai**; then the **Peshwas** (Bajirao I, Nanasaheb) drove pan-Indian expansion.
- Defeat at **Panipat (1761)**, recovery under **Madhavrao I** and **Mahadji Shinde**; ended by the **three Anglo-Maratha wars (1775–1818)**.
- Cultural contributions: **Modi script**, Sanskrit seal, **Ahilyabai Holkar**, and the **Thanjavur Marathas (Serfoji II)**.

Chapter 4 — The Colonial Era in India

Class 8 Social Science · Exploring Society: India and Beyond

BIG QUESTIONS

- What is colonialism?
- What drew European powers to India?
- What was India's economic and geopolitical standing before and during the colonial period?
- How did the British colonial domination of India impact the country?

The Age of Colonialism

DEFINITION
Colonialism — the practice where one country takes control of another region, establishes settlements there, and imposes its political, economic and cultural systems.

- Traceable to ancient empires; the "Age of Colonialism" refers to Europe's expansion from the 15th century onward.
- European powers: Spain, Portugal, Britain, France, Netherlands — established colonies across Africa, Asia, the Americas, Australia, and Pacific islands.
- Often achieved through conquest involving massacre or enslavement of native populations.

Why Did Europeans Colonise?

- **Political competition** — race for territorial expansion and global influence.
- **Economic advantage** — access to new natural resources, new markets, new trade routes, and plunder.
- **Religion** — converting indigenous populations to Christianity.
- **Scientific inquiry** — desire to explore unknown lands and accumulate knowledge of geography and natural history.

REALITY CHECK
Colonisers claimed a "civilising mission" but the reality was loss of independence, exploitation of resources, destruction of traditional ways of life, and imposition of foreign cultural values. Benefits went mostly to the colonisers.

Europeans in India

- India traded with Greeks and Romans over two millennia ago — spices, cotton, ivory, gems, sandalwood, teakwood, wootz steel.
- Until the 16th century CE, India contributed at least **one-fourth of world GDP** (Angus Maddison) — one of the two largest economies globally alongside China.
- European travellers described India as "flourishing" — manufacturing capabilities, diverse agriculture, extensive trade networks.

TIMELINE

1498 — Vasco da Gama's arrival at Kappad, near Kozhikode (Calicut), Kerala.
1510 — Portuguese capture Goa.
1560 — Establishment of the Inquisition at Goa (abolished 1812).
1612–1690 — English East India Company establishes trading posts at Surat, Madras, Bombay and Calcutta.
1674 — French East India Company sets up a trading post at Pondicherry.
1741 — Battle of Colachel; Dutch defeated by Travancore.
1757 — British victory at the Battle of Plassey.
1835 — Macaulay's Minute on Indian Education.
1848–49 — Fall of the Sikh Empire; the East India Company annexes Punjab.
1857 — The Great Indian Rebellion.
1858 — The British Crown ends the rule of the East India Company; start of the British Raj.

The Portuguese: Commerce and Atrocities

- Vasco da Gama arrived at Kappad (1498); aggressive ways — seized, tortured and killed Indian merchants; bombarded Calicut.
- Captured strategic ports including **Goa (1510)** — capital of their colony in India.
- **Cartaz system** — all ships in the Arabian Sea had to purchase Portuguese permits; ships without permits were seized.
- Monopolised the spice trade between India and Europe for nearly a century.
- **Inquisition in Goa (1560)** — persecuted Hindus, Muslims, Jews, and Christian converts; forced conversions; destruction of Hindu temples.

> **LOCAL RESISTANCE**
> **Rani Abbakka I** controlled Ullal (present-day southern Karnataka); formed alliances and thwarted Portuguese attempts; captured and died fighting in prison. Her successor **Rani Abbakka II** created fireballs from coconut shells and set Portuguese ships on fire. Their stories are remembered through *Yakshagana*.

The Dutch: Commerce and Competition

- Arrived early 17th century; focused on commercial dominance, especially spice trade.
- Dutch East India Company — trading posts at Surat, Bharuch, Cochin (west coast), Nagapattinam, Masulipatnam (east coast).
- Most significant presence in Malabar region of Kerala.
- Declined after **Battle of Colachel (1741)** — forces of Travancore under King Marthanda Varma decisively defeated them — rare instance of an Asian power repelling a European colonial force.

The French: Colonial Ambitions

- First trading post at Surat (1668), then Pondicherry (1674); established the *Compagnie des Indes Orientales*.
- **Dupleix** (Governor-General, 1742–1754) pioneered strategies later adopted by the British: trained Indian soldiers as *sepoys*; indirect rule through puppet Indian rulers.
- Ambitions checked during the **Carnatic Wars (1746–1763)**; French reduced to Pondicherry and a few smaller enclaves.
- Rare exception to non-interference: destruction of Pondicherry's Vedapurishwaran temple (1748) ordered by Dupleix.

Enter the British

From Traders to Rulers

- English East India Company — royal charter from Queen Elizabeth I; right to raise a private army.
- Initially pretended to be mere traders; established footholds: Surat, Madras, Bombay, Calcutta.
- Local rulers welcomed foreign trade (longstanding practice in India); Company's long-term ambitions concealed.

The Strategy of Divide and Rule

- Cultivated political relationships; offered military support to some rulers against rivals; emerged as power brokers.
- Played on rivalries between regional rulers and succession disputes.
- Exploited existing divisions within Indian society — religious tensions.

Event / Policy	Details
Battle of Plassey (1757)	Tensions between Siraj-ud-daulah (Nawab of Bengal) and Company officials led by Robert Clive. Clive conspired with Mir Jafar (Nawab's military commander), promising to install him as Nawab in exchange for betrayal. At Palashi (Plassey), Mir Jafar's forces — the majority of the Nawab's army — stood aside, ensuring a British victory. "Mir Jafar" remains a synonym for "traitor" in India.
Doctrine of Lapse	Any princely state would be annexed if its ruler died without a natural male heir. Deliberately disregarded the Hindu tradition of adoption. Led to annexation of numerous states; contributed to the 1857 Rebellion.
Subsidiary Alliance	A British 'Resident' installed in Indian courts to "protect" rulers. Rulers had to maintain British troops at their own expense and conduct foreign relations only through the British. Effectively transferred real power to the British while burdening Indian rulers with the costs of their own subjugation. Hyderabad was among the first (1798). "Empire on the cheap."

> **TERM**
> ***Princely state*** — a region under an Indian prince, maharaja or nawab, but which had accepted British protection and guidance in exchange for internal autonomy. At Independence, there were over 500 princely states, covering about 40% of the Subcontinent.

From Paradise to Hell? — Devastating Famines

- After Plassey, the Company secured the right to collect revenue in Bengal, Bihar and Odisha — some of India's richest regions. Clive described Bengal as "the paradise of the earth."
- Company agents extracted maximum revenue while investing minimally in governance or development.

Famine	Key Facts
Bengal Famine 1770–72	Came on top of two years of crop failure. Harsh revenue collection targets required farmers to pay high cash taxes regardless of harvest conditions. Killed nearly one-third of Bengal's population — an estimated 10 million people. The Company maintained harsh targets and even increased land tax during the famine.
Great Famine 1876–78	Up to 8 million Indians perished, mostly in the Deccan plateau. The British continued to export grain — about one million tonnes of rice per year during the three years of famine. Viceroy Lord Lytton ordered that "there is to be no interference of any kind on the part of the Government with the object of reducing the price of food." At the height of the famine he organised an extravagant durbar in Delhi with a week-long feast for 68,000 officials, satraps and maharajas.
Total Toll	Severe famines during British rule numbered between a dozen and over 20. Estimates of total human victims range between 50 and 100 million — nearly the number of deaths caused by World War II.

- W.W. Hunter (British official) wrote of 1770: "the people went on dying... they sold their sons and daughters, till at length no buyer of children could be found; they ate the leaves of trees and the grass of the field."
- British policy of "free market" left commodity prices free to fluctuate, worsening the severity.
- Some Indian traders held back stocks hoping for price rises, causing artificial scarcity.
- Relief camps were opened but far too few with inadequate supplies. The Famine Commission of 1878–80 stated that the doctrine that the poor are entitled to demand relief in time of famine "would probably lead to the doctrine that they are entitled to such relief at all times."
- Famines had occurred throughout Indian history due to droughts, floods and wars — but never on such a scale. Rural India sank into deep poverty and never recovered.

The Drain of India's Wealth

- **Brooks Adams (1895)** — "Very soon after [the Battle of] Plassey, the Bengal plunder began to arrive in London... for all authorities agree that the 'industrial revolution'... began with the year 1760. Possibly since the world began no investment has ever yielded the profit reaped from the Indian plunder."
- Britain's Industrial Revolution was made possible at least partly by stolen wealth from India (phrase used by historian Will Durant).
- **Dadabhai Naoroji** — *Poverty and Un-British Rule in India* (1901); compiled from British reports the wealth drained out of India. He was also an MP in the House of Commons in 1892.
- **Romesh Chunder Dutt** — *Economic History of India*.
- Recent estimate by **Utsa Patnaik** (1765–1938): **45 trillion U.S. dollars** (in today's value) — about 13 times Britain's GDP in 2023. Extracted not just through taxes, but by charging Indians for the colonial power's expenditure on railways, telegraph network, and even wars.

Changing Landscapes

Decline of India's Indigenous Industries

- Before the 18th century, India was renowned for manufacturing, particularly textiles — cotton, silk, wool, jute, hemp and coir.
- Indian cotton textiles — rich designs, bright colours, ultra-thin muslins to richly embossed fabrics — in high demand worldwide.
- British policy: heavy duties on Indian textiles imported into Britain; India forced to accept British manufactured goods with minimal tariffs. Britain controlled most sea trade and exchange rates.
- Result: ruin of the Indian textile industry. Skilled artisan communities reduced to poverty; forced back to subsistence agriculture on increasingly overtaxed land.
- Governor-General **William Bentinck** observed in 1834: "The bones of the cotton weavers are bleaching the plains of India."
- Similar scenarios for iron, steel, paper and other goods. India's share of world GDP declined to hardly **5%** at the time of Independence.

Dismantling Traditional Governance Structures

- Before colonisation, India had well-organised systems of local self-governance: village councils managed community affairs, resolved disputes, organised public works.
- Regional kingdoms maintained complex administrative structures evolved over centuries.

- **Charles Metcalfe** (acting Governor-General, 1830s): "The village communities are little republics, having nearly everything they want within themselves... Dynasty after dynasty tumbles down; revolution succeeds to revolution; but the village community remains the same."
- British systematically dismantled these indigenous systems, replacing them with a centralised bureaucracy designed primarily to facilitate tax collection and maintain order.
- British codes of law disregarded customary laws and practices; courts became expensive, time-consuming, and conducted in a foreign language.

Transforming Indian Education: Creating 'Brown Englishmen'

- India had diverse educational traditions — *pathashalas*, *madrasas*, *viharas*, and apprenticeship learning.
- British reports in the early 19th century counted 100,000 to 150,000 village schools in Bengal and Bihar alone up to 1830.
- Turning point: **Thomas B. Macaulay's 'Minute on Indian Education' (1835)**. He admitted "no knowledge of either Sanskrit or Arabic" but asserted: "a single shelf of a good European library was worth the whole native literature of India and Arabia."
- Objective: create a class of Indians "Indian in blood and colour, but English in taste, in opinions, in morals, and in intellect."
- Traditional schools slowly disappeared; English became a language of prestige — creating lasting divisions between English-educated elites and the masses.
- New system created a pool of Indian clerks and minor officials to staff the lower ranks cheaply; sidelined traditional sources of knowledge and authority.

Reshaping Economic Structures to Serve Imperial Needs

- India's economy transformed from self-sufficient agriculture + craft/manufacture into a supplier of raw materials for British industry and a market forced to buy British goods.
- **Railways** — designed primarily to move raw materials from the interior to ports for export and to distribute British manufactured goods. Routes ignored existing trade patterns. Another purpose: move armies quickly to fight distant rebellions or wars.
- Railways were not a gift — most were paid for by Indian tax revenue. Same applies to the telegraph network.
- Even administrative costs of colonialism — bureaucracy, military installations, lavish lifestyles of British officials — were financed by Indian taxation. **Indians funded their own subjugation.**

Early Resistance Movements: Challenging Colonial Authority

> *India was the "jewel in the crown of the British Empire." Yet almost from the beginning of the conquest, resistance movements arose.*

Movement	Key Facts
Sannyasi-Fakir Rebellion	One of the earliest organised resistance movements; began in Bengal after the famine of 1770. Groups of *sannyasis* (Hindu ascetics) and *fakirs* (Muslim ascetics), who traditionally travelled freely for pilgrimage and charity, found their movements restricted by Company land and taxation policies. Over the next three decades they attacked British treasuries and tax collectors. The British called them "bandits", executed some, and eventually defeated them with superior forces. Inspired Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay's novel *Anandamath* (1882), which contained the song 'Vande Mataram' — India's national song.
Tribal uprisings — causes	The British described tribals as "primitive", restricted access to forests and forest produce, acquired tribal land or turned it into private property, imposed cash taxes, trapped tribals in debt, replaced traditional tribal councils with the British legal system, and encouraged missionaries to convert them. A colonial law categorised hundreds of tribal communities as "criminal tribes", causing decades of unjust harassment.
Kol Uprising (1831–32)	In Chota Nagpur (present-day Jharkhand). Started when the British introduced land policies favouring outsiders over original tribal inhabitants. The Kol tribes (including the Mundas and Oraons) temporarily established control over significant territory before being defeated.
Santhal Rebellion (1855–56)	A widespread uprising of the Santhal people across parts of present-day Jharkhand, Bihar and West Bengal, led by two brothers, **Sidhu and Kanhu Murmu**. They rebelled against moneylenders and landlords taking away ancestral lands with British support. The Santhals declared their own government and vowed to "fight to the last drop of blood". The British burned entire villages and killed thousands, including the rebel leaders. It inspired other tribal communities to resist.
Indigo Revolt (1859–62)	European planters forced peasants in northern Bengal to abandon food crops and grow indigo instead, as indigo dye was in great demand in Europe. Everyone profited except the peasants, who were so poorly paid they fell into debt slavery. Those who refused faced imprisonment, torture and destruction of property. The uprising was directed mostly at the planters, who hired mercenaries to attack peasants. Educated Bengalis and the Bengali press supported the cause; the British authorities were eventually forced to restrict some of the worst abuses.

The Great Rebellion of 1857

- The British called it the "Sepoy Mutiny". *Sepoys* were Indian soldiers enrolled in the East India Company's British Army; officers were almost all British.
- After Independence, historians rejected the term "Sepoy Mutiny"; the event is called the **Great Rebellion of 1857**.
- Earlier warning sign: **Vellore Mutiny (1806)** — new uniform regulations violated religious practices of Hindu and Muslim sepoys (forbidden to wear religious marks, required to shave beards). Sepoys seized Vellore fort; British crushed the revolt, killing or executing hundreds.
- Most sepoys were from agricultural families suffering great hardship under British land revenue policies.
- Rumours spread that rifle cartridges were greased with cow and pig fat, offending Hindu and Muslim religious sensibilities.
- **Mangal Pandey** at Barrackpore attacked British officers; his execution spread further discontent.
- At Meerut, sepoys killed British officers and marched to Delhi, proclaiming the elderly Mughal emperor **Bahadur Shah Zafar** as their leader.
- Revolt spread across northern and central India — sepoys captured Kanpur, Lucknow, Jhansi.
- At Kanpur, rebel forces under Nana Saheb initially agreed to give safe passage to British civilians, but then massacred over 200 men, women and children.
- British response: recaptured Delhi (September 1857) — house-to-house massacres; mass executions at Kanpur; burned villages and destroyed crops.
- The uprising failed (lack of unified command and consistent strategy) but marked a turning point — foreign domination was unacceptable.
- In 1858, the British Crown took direct control from the East India Company — start of the **British Raj**. Indian Army reorganised to prevent unified resistance.

TWO HEROINES

Rani Lakshmibai of Jhansi — fought bravely to save her kingdom; assisted by Tatia Tope; escaped besieged Jhansi; conquered Gwalior fort; killed on 18 June 1858. British officer noted she was "remarkable for her beauty, cleverness, perseverance [and] generosity... best and bravest of the rebels."

Begum Hazrat Mahal of Awadh — resisted after her kingdom was annexed; led defence of Lucknow; rejected British offers of safe passage; took refuge in Nepal. Issued a counter-proclamation warning Indians not to trust British assurances.

Legacy of European Colonialism in India

- Not a "civilising mission" — India's civilisation was much older than Europe's. Process of subjugation and exploitation executed systematically, with brutal repression if necessary.
- Unintended consequences: opened (or re-opened) India to the world; surveys, documentation of monuments, archaeology.
- Theft of thousands of statues, paintings, jewels, manuscripts — sent to European museums; ongoing repatriation debates.
- British scholars published first translations of Sanskrit texts into European languages (Charles Wilkins, 1785 — Bhagavad Gita).
- Indian texts influenced European philosophers, writers, poets, artists — "discovery of a new continent" (Hegel).
- Political domination may flow in one direction, but cultural influence sometimes flows in the opposite direction.

KEY TAKEAWAYS — THE COLONIAL ERA IN INDIA

- ★ Portuguese → Dutch → French → British; British gained the upper hand.
- ★ Famines killed 50–100 million; wealth drain funded Britain's Industrial Revolution (45 trillion USD estimate).
- ★ Deindustrialisation, dismantling of local governance, Macaulay's education policy (1835).
- ★ Resistance: Sannyasi-Fakir, Kol, Santhal, Indigo, and the Great Rebellion of 1857.
- ★ 1857 → British Crown rule; legacy of exploitation, cultural loss, and some unintended consequences.

Chapter 5 — Universal Franchise and India's Electoral System

Class 8 Social Science · Exploring Society: India and Beyond

BIG QUESTIONS

- What is universal adult franchise?
- What is an electoral system?
- How does India's electoral system work?

Universal Adult Franchise

DEFINITION
Universal adult franchise — every adult citizen (18+) has the right to vote, irrespective of caste, creed, race, religion, gender, education, income. Every vote has equal value.

- Article 326 of the Constitution.
- India among early nations to grant women voting rights — ahead of Switzerland (1971) and others.
- Before Independence: only 13% of Indians could vote.
- 2024 elections: about **980 million** eligible voters; **543 constituencies**.
- India has **3.1 million** elected representatives in over 250,000 local bodies.
- No one can vote on another's behalf; registration as a voter in one's constituency is required.

IMPORTANCE OF UNIVERSAL FRANCHISE
Everyone is equal; no discrimination based on caste, creed, sex, education, wealth. Fosters civic engagement; power to determine one's future; elected representatives accountable to electorate; all can participate in deciding the nation's future.

Bridging Barriers — Ensuring Universal Franchise

- Election Commission of India (ECI) organises elections — independent constitutional body.
- Measures: home voting for elderly/disabled (2024 first time), postal voting, braille-enabled voter cards, app-based requests for assistance, wheelchairs and ramps.
- 2024: about 34% of eligible voters did not vote.
- Uttaramerur inscriptions (10th century) — transparent process for selecting representatives; names on palm leaves drawn randomly from a pot.

The Role of the Election Commission of India (ECI)

- Established 1950; conducts elections to Lok Sabha, Rajya Sabha, State Legislative Assemblies, and offices of President and Vice President.
- First general elections: 1951–1952.
- Tasks: set election dates, register political parties, enforce Model Code of Conduct, oversee entire electoral process.
- Structure: Chief Election Commissioner + two Election Commissioners (national); Chief Electoral Officers (state); District Election Officers; Returning Officers; Electoral Registration Officers.
- **T.N. Seshan** — CEC 1990; reforms: voter IDs, strict vigilance on spending, precise campaigning rules.

Types of Elections

Election	Method	Key Details
Lok Sabha	Direct election, universal adult franchise	543 constituencies; First-Past-the-Post system; 84 seats reserved for SC, 47 for ST; 412 general.
State Legislative Assemblies	Direct election	MLAs; similar process to Lok Sabha; focus on regional issues.
Rajya Sabha	Indirect election	233 elected by MLAs; 12 nominated by President; single transferable vote; permanent house; 1/3 retire every 2 years; 6-year term.
President	Indirect election	Electoral College: MPs + MLAs of states & UTs (Delhi, Puducherry); single transferable vote.
Vice President	Indirect election	Electoral College: elected + nominated members of both Houses of Parliament; single transferable vote.

Who Does NOT Vote in Presidential Election?

- Nominated members of Rajya Sabha (12)
- Nominated members of State Legislative Assemblies
- Members of Legislative Councils (both elected and nominated) in bicameral legislatures
- Nominated members of union territories of Delhi and Puducherry

Reason: Ensures only directly elected representatives vote — maintains democratic legitimacy.

Electoral System — First-Past-the-Post

- Candidate with the most votes wins, even without 50%.
- Example: Gurmat won with 12 out of 33 votes.
- **NOTA** — None Of The Above; allows voters to reject all candidates. Doesn't change result but sends a message.

Model Code of Conduct (MCC)

- Rules for free and fair elections: no new schemes by government that may influence voters; peaceful campaigning; no bribery (gifts in return for votes is punishable).
- Adopted in Kerala (1960); voluntarily approved by major political parties.
- ECI circulated during 1962 general elections; proactive from 1991.

Understanding Elections in India — A Brief Overview

- India follows a parliamentary system; citizens participate at national, state, and local levels.
- 543 constituencies for Lok Sabha; elected candidates = MPs; state assembly = MLAs.
- First-Past-the-Post system: candidate with most votes wins.
- Majority party/coalition in Lok Sabha forms national government; leader becomes Prime Minister.
- Majority party/coalition in State Assembly forms state government; leader becomes Chief Minister.
- State Election Commission manages local body elections (gram panchayats, urban local bodies).

Challenges and the Road Ahead

- Growing influence of money in elections.
- Significant proportion of candidates with criminal records.
- Voter apathy, particularly in urban areas.
- Way forward: empowering voters with information; media, education, awareness campaigns; youth participation; responsible voting.

KEY TAKEAWAYS — UNIVERSAL FRANCHISE

- ★ Universal adult franchise: every citizen 18+ can vote, irrespective of background.
- ★ ECI conducts elections; independent constitutional body; T.N. Seshan's reforms.
- ★ Lok Sabha: direct, FPTP; Rajya Sabha: indirect, single transferable vote; President/Vice President: indirect.
- ★ NOTA, MCC, and ECI accessibility measures ensure fair and inclusive elections.
- ★ Challenges: money power, criminal records, voter apathy — awareness is key.

Chapter 6 — The Parliamentary System: Legislature and Executive

Class 8 Social Science · Exploring Society: India and Beyond

BIG QUESTIONS

- What is India's parliamentary system, and how is it structured?
- What are the key functions of the Parliament?
- What are the roles of the legislature and the executive in India's Parliamentary democracy?
- How are the legislature and the executive organised at the union and state levels?

Introduction

- Constitution of independent India — foundational principles including **Universal Adult Franchise**.
- People directly elect MPs to Lok Sabha; majority group forms the government.
- Parliament = supreme legislative body; makes laws; controls and guides government.
- 18th Lok Sabha constituted June 2024.
- Old Parliament (now Samvidhan Sadan) constructed in 1920s; new Parliament building (Sansad Bhavan) has three-sided design, green construction, and houses ancient symbols.

Composition of the Parliament of India

- President + two Houses: **Lok Sabha** (House of the People / Lower House) and **Rajya Sabha** (Council of States / Upper House) — *bicameral* system.
- Lok Sabha: max 550 members; direct election; 5-year term; Speaker presides.
- Rajya Sabha: 245 members (233 elected by MLAs, 12 nominated by President); permanent house; 1/3 retire every 2 years; 6-year term; Vice President is chairperson.
- **Sengol** — gold-plated silver sceptre; symbolically handed to Nehru on 14 August 1947; placed near Speaker's chair; symbol of righteous and just rule; Nandi at top symbolises justice.
- Translation services in 18 languages: Hindi, English, Assamese, Bengali, Gujarati, Kannada, Malayalam, Marathi, Odia, Tamil, Punjabi, Telugu, Bodo, Dogri, Maithili, Manipuri, Urdu, Sanskrit.

Legislative Functions of the Parliament

1. Constitutional Functions

- Uphold core values of the Constitution: parliamentary democracy through universal adult suffrage; separation of powers; federalism; Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles.
- Election of President and Vice President; amendments to the Constitution.

2. Lawmaking

- Bill → readings → committee → debate → vote → other House → President's assent → Gazette notification.
- Example: **Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009 (RTE)** — roots in Directive Principles; 86th Constitutional Amendment Act 2002 (Article 21A); passed in Lok Sabha August 2009.
- **Money Bill** — can be introduced only in Lok Sabha; requires prior recommendation of the President.

3. Executive Accountability

- Prime Minister and Council of Ministers responsible for implementing laws.
- **Question Hour** — MPs ask ministers questions about policies and activities.
- Standing Committees — MPs from different parties hold ministries accountable.

4. Financial Accountability

- Parliament approves and monitors government expenditure through the annual budget.
- Government must provide timely and accurate information to Parliament.

Executive Functions of Parliament

The President

- Head of State and nominal head of the Executive.
- Appoints Prime Minister and other ministers; summons Parliament; gives assent to bills.
- Council of Ministers aids and advises the President.
- Discretionary powers during political crises (e.g., no clear majority in Lok Sabha election).

The Prime Minister and the Council of Ministers

- Prime Minister — de facto executive authority; leader of majority party/coalition in Lok Sabha.
- Key functions: leads Council of Ministers; coordinates ministries; advises President; shapes national policies.
- Council of Ministers — chosen from MPs; collectively responsible to Lok Sabha.
- Most bills initiated by the government.
- Civil servants (administrators/bureaucrats) implement laws and policies under direction of ministers.

> **EXAMPLE OF MORAL RESPONSIBILITY**
> In 1956, Railway Minister **Lal Bahadur Shastri** resigned after a train accident. Although not blamed, he believed a minister must take moral responsibility for anything in their ministry. Nehru declined at first, but Shastri insisted; resignation was accepted.

Legislature vs Executive — Key Differences

Aspect	Legislature	Executive
Composition	President + Lok Sabha + Rajya Sabha	President + Vice President + Council of Ministers
Main Role	Making laws; overseeing Executive	Enforcing laws made by Legislature
Functions	Can introduce some bills; keeps check via questions; sanctions expenses; consults committees	Most bills introduced; provides information; prepares/implements budget; functions independently in day-to-day matters

The Judiciary — Role of Checks and Balances

- Interprets and applies laws; system of courts.
- Custodian of the Constitution — ensures all branches operate within constitutional principles.
- Checks Legislature: laws must not violate Constitutional framework.
- Checks Executive: actions must respect Constitution.
- Separation of powers ensures no organ becomes too powerful.

Legislative and Executive Functions at the State Level

- Each state has its own legislature and executive — State Assembly (Vidhan Sabha).
- MLAs formulate laws on State List and Concurrent List.
- **Union List** — Union government exclusively legislates.
- **State List** — State government exclusively legislates.
- **Concurrent List** — both can legislate; Union law prevails.

Feature	Union Government	State Government
Constitutional Head	President of India	Governor appointed by President
Executive Head	Prime Minister (de facto)	Chief Minister (de facto)
Council of Ministers	Selected by PM	Selected by CM
Responsibility	Collectively responsible to Lok Sabha	Collectively responsible to Vidhan Sabha
Legislature	Bicameral — Lok Sabha + Rajya Sabha	Unicameral or bicameral — Vidhan Sabha + Vidhan Parishad (in some states)
Lower House	Lok Sabha (5-year term)	Vidhan Sabha (5-year term)
Upper House	Rajya Sabha (permanent)	Vidhan Parishad (in some states only)
Presiding Officer	Speaker (Lok Sabha)	Speaker (Vidhan Sabha)
Legislative Powers	Union List + Concurrent List	State List + Concurrent List
Financial Powers	Money bills originate only in Lok Sabha	Money bills originate only in Vidhan Sabha

Bicameral States

- Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Telangana, Uttar Pradesh.
- Remaining states have unicameral system.

Challenges to Effective Functioning of Legislatures

- Regular absenteeism of members.
- Non-cooperative conduct; disruptions of Question Hour.
- Reduced quality of important debates.
- Parliament meets three times a year: Budget, Monsoon, Winter Sessions.
- Usually sits for 6 hours a day during sessions.
- Productivity decline: Rajya Sabha 78% (2004–14) → 65% (since then); 2018 lowest at 35.75%.
- Substantial proportion of representatives with criminal cases; angry or biased debates.
- Way forward: informed citizenry, public debate, digital engagement, youth participation.

> **QUOTE**
> Atal Bihari Vajpayee: "Sarkaarein aayengi, jaayengi. Paartiyaan banengi, bigadengi. Lekin yeh desh rehna chaahiey, is desh ka loktantra amar rehna chaahiey." (Governments will come and go, parties will rise and fall. But the nation must endure, and its democracy must live on.)

KEY TAKEAWAYS — THE PARLIAMENTARY SYSTEM

- ★ Parliament = President + Lok Sabha + Rajya Sabha (bicameral).
- ★ Legislature makes laws; Executive enforces them; Judiciary checks both — separation of powers.
- ★ PM is de facto executive; Council of Ministers responsible to Lok Sabha; Question Hour ensures accountability.
- ★ State level: Vidhan Sabha + Vidhan Parishad (in some states); CM is de facto executive.
- ★ Challenges: disruptions, absenteeism, criminal records — citizen awareness and participation are key.

Chapter 7 — Factors of Production

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BIG QUESTIONS

- What are the factors of production?
- How are these factors interconnected?
- What is the role of human capital in production, and what are its facilitators?

Introduction

- Every product goes through a production process combining resources or inputs — **factors of production**.
- **Business** — a firm, shop, or factory that produces or sells goods or provides a service.
- Example: Ratna runs **Pause Point**, a restaurant; combined land, labour, capital, entrepreneurship.

Four Factors of Production

> *Inputs classified into four types: land, labour, capital, and entrepreneurship. Technology is a facilitator.*

Land (Natural Resources)

- Includes geographical land, soil, forests, water, air, sunlight, minerals, oil, natural gas.
- Businesses either purchase land or pay rent.

Labour (Human Resources)

- Physical and mental effort used in production — carpenters, farmers, teachers, doctors.
- **Human capital** — specialised skills, knowledge, abilities, and expertise required to perform labour.

> **NOTE**
> Labour = basic physical/mental effort. Human capital = quality and efficiency of that labour (skills, knowledge, expertise).

Capital

- Monetary resources + durable assets — machinery, tools, equipment, vehicles, computers, shops, factories.
- Sources: personal savings, family, friends, bank loans, stock market (shares/dividends).

Entrepreneurship

- Starting a business or creating something new to solve a problem.
- Entrepreneur: identifies a problem, takes risks, combines factors, makes decisions, contributes to society.
- **Startup** — an entrepreneurial venture with limited resources aiming for rapid growth using technology.

> **J.R.D. TATA**
> Entrepreneur, industrialist, philanthropist; started Tata Airlines (1932), later Air India; expanded Tata Group into steel, cars, power, chemicals. Bharat Ratna 1992. Believed businesses should help society and care for workers.

Human Capital and Its Facilitators

> *Human capital is the knowledge, skills, experience, and ability of individuals that create economic value.*

Facilitator	Role
Education & Training	Builds knowledge, problem-solving, and job-specific skills (e.g., civil engineering student learns design, then trains on site).
Healthcare	Supports cognitive development, physical/mental fitness, productivity, creativity, and reduced absenteeism.
Social & Cultural Influences	Culture of hard work, continuous improvement (e.g., Japanese *kaizen*, German work ethic) raises quality and standards.

Challenges to Human Capital

- Adult literacy rate (2023): Males 85%, Females 70% (World Bank estimates).
- India has a young population — 65% below age 35 (Economic Survey 2024) — **demographic dividend** potential.
- Requires quality education, health, training, and skilling.

Technology: An Enabler of Production

- Technology = application of scientific knowledge.
- Examples: UPI payments, weather updates for farmers, GPS for transport, drones for farming, robots in surgery.
- Old technologies (pulleys, wheelbarrows) still in use.
- Online platforms: **SWAYAM** (MOOCs for Grade 9+), **National Career Service** (job portal).
- Technology eliminates geographical barriers — access to knowledge, skill development, and jobs.

How Are the Factors Connected?

- Factors complement each other; proportion used depends on the product.
- **Labour-intensive** — agriculture, construction, handicrafts.
- **Capital-intensive** — semiconductor chips, satellites.
- Technology can change proportions (e.g., machines reduce labour dependence; 3-D printing revives handloom).
- **Supply chain** — network of individuals, organisations, resources, activities, and technology involved in production and sale.
- Geographic interconnectedness provides access to varied inputs; disruptions (e.g., COVID-19) can halt production.

MOBILE PHONE MANUFACTURING FLOW

R&D team conceptualises → Acquire land and set up factory → Acquire raw materials → Assemble components & install software → Test phone → Mass production & packaging → Distribution to retail stores. Human effort involved at every stage.

Responsibilities Towards Factors of Production

- **Environmental** — reduce waste, avoid pollution, recycle, replenish resources (e.g., leather factories pollute rivers; e-waste leaks lead/mercury).
- **Workers** — fair compensation, safe conditions, skill development, workplace rights, anti-discrimination, benefits.
- **CSR** — India was first nation to mandate 2% of average profits for CSR (2014).

KEY TAKEAWAYS — FACTORS OF PRODUCTION

- ★ Four factors: Land, Labour, Capital, Entrepreneurship; Technology is a facilitator.
- ★ Human capital = skills + knowledge + expertise; built by education, training, healthcare, culture.
- ★ Factors are interconnected; proportion varies by product (labour-intensive vs capital-intensive).
- ★ India's demographic dividend depends on quality education, health, and skilling.
- ★ Businesses must act responsibly toward environment and workers (CSR, fair wages, sustainability).